LIBRO DE GRAMÁTICA · C1 TRACKER

Inglés de B1 a C1
Nivel B1+

Teoría, práctica y lecturas desmontadas para estudiar en papel. Es el mismo contenido que la app, unidad por unidad. Las soluciones están al final: no las mires hasta terminar cada ejercicio.

Unidad 1 · El esqueleto de la frase
Sujeto, verbo y complementos. Cómo leer frases largas.

Unidad 2 · Oraciones de relativo
who, which, that, whose, where. Cuándo se omiten.

Unidad 3 · Present perfect o past simple
Pasado terminado frente a pasado conectado con el presente.

Unidad 4 · La pasiva
Quién recibe la acción. Todos los tiempos.

Unidad 5 · Conectores de contraste y causa
although, however, despite, because of, so…

Unidad 6 · Narrar en pasado
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Unidad 7 · Condicionales 0, 1 y 2
Situaciones reales e hipotéticas.

Unidad 8 · Verbo + -ing o + to
enjoy doing, decide to do, stop/remember/try.

Anexo · Verbos irregulares

B1+ · UNIDAD 1

El esqueleto de la frase

Sujeto, verbo y complementos. Cómo leer frases largas.

📖 Teoría

La idea clave

Toda frase en inglés, por larga que sea, tiene un **esqueleto**: **sujeto** + **verbo** (y casi siempre algo que completa al verbo). Todo lo demás son piezas que cuelgan de ese esqueleto.

Cuando una frase larga te lía, el problema casi nunca es que no conozcas las palabras: es que intentas entenderla **de izquierda a derecha, palabra por palabra**. En inglés funciona mejor **buscar primero el esqueleto** y después ir colgando el resto.

> **The man is a doctor.**
>
> **The man who lives next door to my parents is a doctor.**

Las dos frases dicen lo mismo en lo esencial: *el hombre es médico*. La segunda solo añade *qué hombre*.

El orden en inglés es casi fijo

En español podemos mover las piezas («Llegó ayer mi hermano», «Mi hermano llegó ayer»). En inglés el orden normal es siempre:

Sujeto → Verbo → Complemento → (lugar) → (tiempo)

> **My brother arrived yesterday.** ✓
>
> ~~Arrived yesterday my brother.~~ ✗

Y el sujeto **siempre aparece**, aunque en español lo quitemos:

> ~~Is raining.~~ ✗ → **It is raining.** ✓
>
> ~~Is important to rest.~~ ✗ → **It is important to rest.** ✓

Esto es una ventaja al leer: **lo que va justo delante del verbo principal es (casi siempre) el sujeto**.

Cómo reconocer el verbo principal

El verbo principal es el que está **conjugado** (lleva tiempo: presente, pasado, futuro…). Los auxiliares van con él y forman un solo bloque:

> **works** · **has been working** · **will work** · **can work** · **was built** · **didn't know**

No son el verbo principal:

- Los **infinitivos** con *to*: *She decided to leave* → el principal es *decided*.
- Las formas en **-ing** o **-ed** sin auxiliar delante: *The woman sitting there **is** my aunt* → el principal es *is*.
- Los verbos que van **después de who, which, that, because, when, if, although…**: pertenecen a una oración secundaria.

Las piezas que cuelgan del esqueleto

Casi todo lo que hace larga una frase es una de estas cinco piezas. Aprende a reconocerlas por la palabra con la que empiezan:

Pieza	Empieza por…	Ejemplo
Relativa	who, which, that, whose, where	the book that I bought
Subordinada	because, when, if, although, while, since, after	Although it was late, we went out.
Preposición + nombre	in, on, at, with, for, of, during…	During the summer, prices rise.
Participio	-ing, -ed (sin auxiliar)	the money spent on education
Conector	however, therefore, moreover, and, but	However, nobody noticed.

Truco: **tapa mentalmente esas piezas** y lo que queda es el esqueleto.

El método de los 4 pasos

1. **Busca los verbos conjugados** de la frase.
2. **Descarta** los que van detrás de who/which/that/because/when/if/although…
3. El que queda es el **verbo principal**. Lo que va delante es el **sujeto** (quita las piezas que cuelgan de él).
4. Lee el esqueleto en voz alta y **después** añade las piezas una a una.

> **Last year**, **the company that my sister works for** **opened** **three new offices** **in Asia**.

Verbos conjugados: *works* y *opened*. *Works* va detrás de *that* → secundaria. Esqueleto: **the company opened three new offices**. Luego: ¿qué compañía? la de mi hermana. ¿Cuándo? el año pasado. ¿Dónde? en Asia.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~Is very interesting this book.~~ → **This book is very interesting.** El sujeto va delante.
- ~~Yesterday went I to the cinema.~~ → **Yesterday I went to the cinema.** Aunque empieces por el tiempo, después va sujeto + verbo.
- ~~Exist many problems.~~ → **There are many problems.** Para «hay/existen» se usa *there is / there are*.
- Al leer: tomar el primer verbo que ves como principal. En *People who exercise regularly **sleep** better*, el principal es **sleep**.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. Subraya el verbo principal:

   My neighbour has lived in this building for twenty years.

2. Subraya el verbo principal:

   The students who passed the exam received a certificate.

3. Rodea el sujeto:

   The film that we saw last night was really boring.

4. Subraya el verbo principal:

   Although she was tired, Laura finished the report before midnight.

5. Rodea el sujeto:

   In most European countries, children start school at the age of six.

6. Subraya el verbo principal:

   People who exercise regularly tend to sleep better.

7. ¿Cuál es el esqueleto de esta frase?
   The decision to close the old factory, which had employed hundreds of local people, was announced on Monday.

   a) The decision was announced
   b) The old factory had employed people
   c) Hundreds of people was announced
   d) The factory was announced on Monday

8. ¿Cuál es el verbo principal?
   Anyone wishing to apply for the course should send an email before Friday.

   a) should send
   b) wishing
   c) to apply
   d) apply

9. Elige la frase correcta.

   a) It is important to drink water.
   b) Is important to drink water.
   c) Important is to drink water.
   d) Is important drink water.

10. Elige la frase correcta.

    a) There are many problems in this city.
    b) Exist many problems in this city.
    c) Many problems exist in this city they.
    d) Has many problems this city.

11. Ordena la frase.

    new / car / bought / a / Yesterday / my / parents

---

12. Ordena la frase.

    is / my / woman / The / who / you / called / boss

---

13. _____ is raining again, so take an umbrella.

14. _____ are three restaurants near my house.

🔍 Lectura desmontada: Why we forget what we read

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1]Most of us have had the same experience: we finish a book, and a few weeks later we can remember almost nothing about it. [2]This is not a sign that our memory is getting worse. [3]In fact, researchers who study memory say that forgetting is completely normal. [4]The brain keeps information that it uses often and throws away the rest. [5]When we read a novel in one weekend, we give the brain very few chances to return to the story. [6]People who read a chapter a day and think about it before the next one remember much more. [7]Writing a short summary or explaining the plot to a friend is even more effective. [8]So if you want to remember a book, the answer is simple: read it more slowly and talk about it.

Vocabulario de la lectura

experience	experiencia
almost nothing	casi nada
a sign	una señal
get worse	empeorar
in fact	de hecho
researcher	investigador/a
forgetting	olvidar (el hecho de olvidar)
keep	guardar, conservar
throw away	tirar, desechar
the rest	el resto
novel	novela
chance	oportunidad, ocasión
return to	volver a
chapter	capítulo
the next one	el siguiente
summary	resumen
plot	trama, argumento
effective	eficaz
slowly	despacio

talk about	hablar de

Preguntas

1. According to the text, forgetting what we read...
   a) is a sign of a bad memory.
   b) is completely normal.
   c) only happens with long books.
   d) happens more to older people.

2. Why do we forget a novel we read in one weekend?
   a) Because novels are too long.
   b) Because we read too fast to understand.
   c) Because the brain has few chances to return to the story.
   d) Because we are tired at weekends.

3. What does the writer suggest?
   a) Reading shorter books.
   b) Reading more books.
   c) Reading slowly and talking about the book.
   d) Reading the same book twice.

B1+ · UNIDAD 2

Oraciones de relativo

who, which, that, whose, where. Cuándo se omiten.

📖 Teoría

Para qué sirven

Una oración de relativo es una pieza que **dice algo más de un nombre**: qué persona, qué cosa, qué lugar. Es la pieza que más alarga las frases de los textos, así que reconocerla es la mitad del trabajo al leer.

> I met a woman. *She* speaks six languages.
> → I met a woman **who speaks six languages**.

Qué pronombre usar

Pronombre	Para	Ejemplo
who	personas	the teacher who helped me
which	cosas y animales	the phone which I bought
that	personas o cosas (más informal)	the film that won the prize
whose	posesión («cuyo»)	the man whose car was stolen
where	lugares	the town where I grew up
when	momentos	the day when we met

En español casi siempre decimos «que». En inglés hay que elegir: **personas → who**, **cosas → which**, y **that** vale para las dos.

Con comas o sin comas

Hay dos tipos y cambian el significado:

> **Sin comas (especificativa):** My brother **who lives in London** is a nurse.
> → Tengo varios hermanos; hablo del que vive en Londres.

> **Con comas (explicativa):** My brother, **who lives in London**, is a nurse.
> → Solo tengo un hermano; de paso digo que vive en Londres.

Reglas de las de **comas**: no se puede usar **that** y el pronombre **nunca** se omite.

> My car, ~~that~~ **which** is ten years old, still works perfectly.

Cuándo desaparece el pronombre

Esto es lo que más confunde al leer. Si el pronombre es el **objeto** (detrás viene otro sujeto), en las relativas sin comas se puede **quitar**, y los nativos lo quitan casi siempre:

> The book **(that) I read last summer** was amazing.
>
> The people **(who) we met in Rome** were very friendly.

Pista para leer: si ves **nombre** + **sujeto** + **verbo** seguidos (*the book I read*, *the man she married*), ahí hay una relativa escondida. Mentalmente, añade «que».

> The house **they bought** **needs** a lot of work. → La casa *que* compraron necesita mucho trabajo.

Si el pronombre es el **sujeto** de la relativa (detrás viene directamente el verbo), **no** se puede quitar: *the man who lives here*.

Relativas reducidas (-ing / -ed)

En los textos verás a menudo relativas «comprimidas» sin pronombre ni verbo conjugado:

> the woman **sitting by the window** = the woman who is sitting by the window
>
> a novel **written in 1850** = a novel which was written in 1850
>
> products **made in China** = products which are made in China

-ing = sentido activo (la persona hace algo). **-ed** / **participio** = sentido pasivo (a la cosa le hacen algo). Recuerda de la unidad 1: estas formas **no** son el verbo principal.

Preposición al final

En inglés normal la preposición se queda al final de la relativa. Es muy frecuente y al principio despista:

> the company **my sister works for** → la empresa *para la que* trabaja mi hermana
>
> the person **I was talking to** → la persona *con la que* hablaba

La versión formal pone la preposición delante y obliga a usar **whom** o **which**: *the person to whom I was talking*.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~The book that I read it was great.~~ → **The book that I read was great.** No se repite el objeto («que lo leí»).
- ~~The man which lives here…~~ → **The man who lives here…** Personas con *who*.
- ~~My mother, that is a teacher, …~~ → **My mother, who is a teacher, …** Con comas no hay *that*.
- ~~The city where I live in…~~ → **The city where I live** o **the city I live in**. No las dos cosas.
- ~~A friend who his father is a pilot~~ → **A friend whose father is a pilot**.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. The woman ___ lives upstairs is a musician.
   a) who
   b) which
   c) whose
   d) where

2. This is the café ___ we first met.
   a) where
   b) which
   c) who
   d) whose

3. I have a friend ___ brother plays for Barcelona.
   a) whose
   b) who
   c) who's
   d) which

4. My grandmother, ___ is 90, still drives.
   a) who
   b) that
   c) which
   d) — (nada)

5. ¿En qué frase se puede quitar el pronombre?
   a) The film that we watched was boring.
   b) The film that won the prize was boring.
   c) The man who called you is here.
   d) My car, which is red, is outside.

6. ¿Qué significa?
   The flat they rented was tiny.
   a) El piso que alquilaron era diminuto.
   b) Alquilaron el piso y era diminuto.
   c) Ellos alquilaron un piso diminuto.
   d) El piso alquiló a ellos.

7. ¿Cuál es el verbo principal?
   The students taking the exam tomorrow must bring their ID.
   a) must bring
   b) taking
   c) bring
   d) take

8. Elige la frase correcta.
   a) The book that I lent you was mine.
   b) The book that I lent you it was mine.
   c) The book who I lent you was mine.
   d) The book what I lent you was mine.

9. That's the girl _____ dog bit me.

10. The bus _____ goes to the airport leaves every hour.

11. I'll never forget the day _____ I passed my driving test.

12. Is this the person you were talking _____?

13. Subraya el verbo principal:
    The houses built after the war were quite small.

14. Subraya el verbo principal:
    The restaurant my parents recommended has closed down.

15. Ordena la frase.

The / man / wallet / I / a / reward / gave / me / whose / found

🔍 Lectura desmontada: The library that never closes

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1] In a small village in Wales there is a red telephone box that no longer has a telephone. [2] Instead, the shelves people have built inside it are full of books which anyone can borrow for free. [3] The idea came from a retired teacher whose house is next to the box. [4] She wanted to create a place where neighbours could share the books they had already read. [5] Today the box, which is open day and night, contains more than three hundred books. [6] Visitors passing through the village often stop to take a photo or leave a book of their own. [7] The teacher says that the books people choose to leave tell you a lot about the village.

Vocabulario de la lectura

telephone box	cabina de teléfono
no longer	ya no
instead	en su lugar
shelf / shelves	estante(s)
borrow	tomar prestado
for free	gratis
retired	jubilado/a
next to	al lado de
create	crear
neighbour	vecino/a
share	compartir
day and night	día y noche
contain	contener
pass through	pasar por
leave	dejar
of their own	suyo propio
choose	elegir, decidir
a lot about	mucho sobre

Preguntas

1. What is special about the telephone box?
   a) It is the oldest in Wales.
   b) It is used as a small library.
   c) It still has a working telephone.
   d) It is only open during the day.

2. Who had the idea?
   a) A group of visitors.
   b) The local council.
   c) A retired teacher who lives next to it.
   d) A telephone company.

3. According to the teacher, the books people leave…
   a) are usually very old.
   b) say a lot about the village.
   c) are mostly for children.
   d) are sold to visitors.

B1+ · UNIDAD 3

Present perfect o past simple

Pasado terminado frente a pasado conectado con el presente.

📖 Teoría

La pregunta clave: ¿el momento está terminado?

Los dos tiempos hablan de cosas que pasaron, pero miran el pasado de forma distinta:

Past simple = pasado cerrado · Present perfect = pasado conectado con ahora

> I lost my keys yesterday. → Pasó ayer. Fin de la historia.
>
> I have lost my keys. → Las he perdido y **ahora** no las tengo.

Si dices **cuándo** pasó (yesterday, in 2019, last week, two days ago, when I was a child), el momento está cerrado: **past simple**.

Cómo se forman

	Past simple	Present perfect
+	She **worked** / **went**	She **has worked** / **has gone**
–	She **didn't work**	She **hasn't worked**
?	**Did** she **work**?	**Has** she **worked**?

El present perfect es **have/has** + **participio**. Los verbos irregulares tienen participio propio: *go → went →* ***gone***, *see → saw →* ***seen***, *write → wrote →* ***written***.

Cuándo se usa el present perfect

- **Experiencias** a lo largo de tu vida, sin decir cuándo: *I'**ve been** to Japan twice. · Have you ever **tried** sushi?*
- **Algo que empezó en el pasado y sigue**, con *for* y *since*: *We'**ve lived** here for ten years.* (y seguimos aquí)
- **Un resultado que importa ahora**: *Someone **has broken** the window.* (está rota)
- **Un periodo que aún no ha terminado**: *today, this week, this year*: *I'**ve drunk** three coffees today.*
- Con **just, already, yet**: *She'**s just left**. · Have you finished **yet**? · I'**ve already** paid.*

Palabras que te dan la pista

Past simple	Present perfect
yesterday · last night/week/year · in 2019 · ago · when…? · then	ever · never · just · already · yet · so far · since · for (hasta ahora) · recently

Ojo con «ago»: siempre va con past simple. *I met her two years ago* ✓ · ~~*I have met her two years ago*~~ ✗

Ojo con «for»: depende de si la situación sigue. *I **lived** in Paris for two years* (ya no vivo allí) · *I**'ve lived** in Paris for two years* (sigo viviendo allí).

En los textos: noticias e historias

Las noticias suelen empezar en present perfect (lo nuevo, lo que importa ahora) y luego cuentan los detalles en past simple:

> A local student **has won** a national science prize. She **designed** a cheap water filter and **presented** it in Madrid last month.

Cuando leas, fíjate en este cambio: el present perfect anuncia, el past simple narra.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~I have seen him yesterday.~~ → **I saw him yesterday.** En español decimos «lo he visto hoy/ayer» con más libertad; en inglés, si hay un momento terminado, past simple.
- ~~I live here since 2015.~~ → **I've lived here since 2015.** «Vivo aquí desde…» se dice con present perfect.
- ~~How long are you here?~~ → **How long have you been here?**
- ~~Did you ever go to London?~~ → **Have you ever been to London?** Experiencia en tu vida → present perfect, y con *been to*.

Sujeto · Verbo principal · Complemento · Oración secundaria · Conector · Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. I ___ my phone. I can't find it anywhere.
   a) have lost
   b) lost
   c) lose
   d) was losing

2. We ___ to Italy last summer.
   a) went
   b) have gone
   c) have been
   d) go

3. She ___ in this company since 2020.
   a) has worked
   b) worked
   c) works
   d) is working

4. ___ you ever ___ a horse?
   a) Have / ridden
   b) Did / ride
   c) Have / rode
   d) Did / ridden

5. They got married three years ___.
   a) ago
   b) since
   c) for
   d) before

6. I ___ three coffees today, so no more for me!
   a) 've had
   b) had
   c) have
   d) was having

7. Have you finished your homework _____?

8. I've known Marta _____ we were at school together.

9. He has lived in Berlin _____ six years.

10. When _____ you start learning English?

11. Subraya el verbo principal:
    The number of people who work from home has doubled since 2019.

12. Ordena la frase.
    to / Ireland / never / I / have / been

🔍 Lectura desmontada: The village that went offline

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1] A small village in the north of Scotland has decided to switch off its public Wi-Fi every Sunday. [2] The idea came from a group of parents who were worried about their children's screen time. [3] Last spring they organised a meeting and most of the village voted in favour. [4] Since then, the local café has started a board games afternoon and the library has seen more visitors than ever. [5] Not everyone has been happy, however. [6] Some teenagers complained that they had nothing to do, and two of them walked five kilometres to the next town to find a signal. [7] But so far the experiment has worked and other villages have asked how they can do the same.

Vocabulario de la lectura

switch off	apagar
public	público
be worried about	estar preocupado por
screen time	tiempo de pantalla
vote in favour	votar a favor
meeting	reunión
since then	desde entonces
board game	juego de mesa
than ever	que nunca
however	sin embargo
not everyone	no todo el mundo
complain	quejarse
signal	señal, cobertura
the next town	el pueblo de al lado
so far	hasta ahora
the same	lo mismo

Preguntas

1. What has the village decided to do?
   a) Ban mobile phones.
   b) Turn off public Wi-Fi on Sundays.
   c) Close the library on Sundays.
   d) Build a new café.

2. Who suggested the idea?
   a) The teenagers.
   b) The library staff.
   c) Some worried parents.
   d) The owner of the café.

3. How have other villages reacted?
   a) They have criticised it.
   b) They have asked for information.
   c) They have ignored it.
   d) They have copied it already.

B1+ · UNIDAD 4

La pasiva

Quién recibe la acción. Todos los tiempos.

📖 Teoría

Para qué sirve

En la voz pasiva, el protagonista de la frase es **quien recibe la acción**, no quien la hace. Se usa cuando quién lo hace no importa, no se sabe o es obvio.

> Activa: **Someone stole my bike**.
>
> Pasiva: **My bike was stolen**. → Lo importante es la bici; el ladrón no se sabe.

En los textos (noticias, ciencia, informes) la pasiva aparece muchísimo. Si no la reconoces, entenderás al revés quién hace qué.

Cómo se forma

be (en el tiempo que toque) + participio

Tiempo	Pasiva
Presente	English **is spoken** here.
Pasado	The bridge **was built** in 1890.
Present perfect	The meeting **has been cancelled**.
Futuro	The results **will be published** on Monday.
Continuo	The road **is being repaired**.
Con modal	Phones **must be switched off**.

Truco: el verbo que cambia de tiempo es **be**. El participio siempre se queda igual.

Quién lo hace: by

Si quieres decir quién hizo la acción, usa **by**. Solo se añade cuando aporta información:

> Guernica **was painted by Picasso**. ✓ (dato importante)
>
> My bike was stolen ~~by someone~~. ✗ (no aporta nada)

Cómo reconocerla al leer

Busca **be** + **participio**. Cuidado, porque el participio puede parecer un pasado normal:

> The thief **arrested** the man. → el ladrón arrestó (activa, raro)
>
> The thief **was arrested**. → al ladrón lo arrestaron (pasiva)

Y recuerda la unidad 2: muchas veces la pasiva aparece «comprimida» como relativa reducida, sin *be*:

> The houses **built after the war** are small. = which were built

La pasiva y el «se» español

Muchas frases con «se» en español se dicen en inglés con pasiva:

> Se habla inglés. → English **is spoken**.
>
> Se construyó en 1890. → It **was built** in 1890.
>
> Se cancelaron los vuelos. → The flights **were cancelled**.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~The house was build in 1900.~~ → **was built**. Siempre participio, no infinitivo.
- ~~It is speaking English here.~~ → **English is spoken here.**
- ~~The letter was sended.~~ → **was sent**. Ojo con los irregulares.
- ~~I was born on 1998.~~ → **I was born in 1998.** «Nacer» en inglés es pasiva: *be born*.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. This castle ___ in the 12th century.
   a) was built
   b) built
   c) is building
   d) has built

2. Spanish ___ in more than 20 countries.
   a) is spoken
   b) speaks
   c) is speaking
   d) spoke

3. The match ___ because of the rain.
   a) has been cancelled
   b) has cancelled
   c) is cancelling
   d) cancelled

4. Your order ___ tomorrow morning.
   a) will be delivered
   b) will deliver
   c) is delivering
   d) delivers

5. The road ___ at the moment, so we have to go another way.
   a) is being repaired
   b) is repairing
   c) repairs
   d) has repaired

6. ¿Cuál es correcta?
   a) I was born in 1998.
   b) I born in 1998.
   c) I am born in 1998.
   d) I was borned in 1998.

7. The Mona Lisa was painted _____ Leonardo da Vinci.

8. Mobile phones must _____ switched off during the exam.

9. The winners will be _____ next week. (announce)

10. Subraya el verbo principal:
    More than a million trees have been planted in the region since 2010.

11. Rodea el sujeto:
    The new hospital, which was designed by a local architect, will be opened next year.

12. Ordena la frase.
    by / thief / The / was / arrested / the / police

🔍 Lectura desmontada: How a pencil is made

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1]Billions of pencils are produced every year, but few people know how they are made. [2]First, the wood is cut into thin blocks which are called slats. [3]Then small grooves are made in each slat, and the "lead" is placed inside them. [4]Surprisingly, this "lead" is not made of lead at all: it is a mixture of graphite and clay. [5]A second slat is glued on top, and the "sandwich" is cut into individual pencils. [6]Finally, they are painted, sharpened and packed into boxes. [7]The yellow colour that is used on most American pencils was chosen in the 1890s because the best graphite came from China, where yellow was linked to royalty.

Vocabulario de la lectura

billion	mil millones
produce	producir, fabricar
wood	madera
thin	fino, delgado
be called	llamarse
groove	ranura
place	colocar
inside	dentro
lead	plomo (y la mina del lápiz)
not… at all	en absoluto
mixture	mezcla
clay	arcilla
glue	pegar (con pegamento)
on top	encima
sharpen	sacar punta, afilar
pack	empaquetar
choose (chose, chosen)	elegir
be linked to	estar asociado a
royalty	la realeza

Preguntas

1. What is the "lead" in a pencil made of?
   a) Lead.
   b) Graphite and clay.
   c) Wood and glue.
   d) Paint.

2. What happens after the second slat is glued on top?
   a) The lead is placed inside.
   b) The pencils are painted.
   c) The "sandwich" is cut into pencils.
   d) Grooves are made.

3. Why are many American pencils yellow?
   a) Yellow is the cheapest paint.
   b) It was linked to Chinese royalty.
   c) Yellow is easy to see.
   d) The first pencil was yellow.

B1+ · UNIDAD 5

Conectores de contraste y causa

although, however, despite, because of, so…

📖 Teoría

Por qué importan tanto

Los conectores son las **señales de tráfico** de un texto: te dicen si lo que viene a continuación va en la misma dirección, en contra o es una consecuencia. Si los reconoces, entiendes la lógica del texto aunque no sepas todas las palabras.

> The hotel was expensive. **However**, … → viene algo bueno (contraste)
>
> The hotel was expensive. **As a result**, … → viene una consecuencia

Lo que hay que saber de cada uno: qué va detrás

El gran problema no es el significado, sino la **gramática**: unos van con una frase completa y otros con un sustantivo.

Va con…	Contraste	Causa	Consecuencia
Frase (sujeto + verbo)	although, even though, while, whereas	because, as, since	so
Sustantivo o -ing	despite, in spite of	because of, due to	—
Frase nueva (tras punto o punto y coma)	however, nevertheless, on the other hand	—	therefore, as a result, consequently

Contraste: although, despite, however

> **Although** it was raining, we went out. (frase completa)
>
> **Despite** the rain, we went out. (sustantivo)
>
> **Despite** feeling tired, she kept working. (-ing)
>
> It was raining. **However**, we went out. (frase nueva, con coma detrás)

Even though es un *although* más fuerte. **Whereas** / **while** comparan dos cosas opuestas: *My sister loves cities, whereas I prefer the countryside.*

On the other hand presenta el otro lado de un argumento. **On the contrary** significa «al contrario, es justo lo opuesto», no es lo mismo.

Causa y consecuencia: because, because of, so

> We stayed home **because** it was raining. (frase)
>
> We stayed home **because of** the rain. (sustantivo)
>
> It was raining, **so** we stayed home. (consecuencia)
>
> Prices rose sharply. **As a result**, sales fell. (más formal)

Due to es más formal que *because of*: *The flight was delayed due to fog.*

Al leer, **as** y **since** pueden despistar: a veces significan «porque» (*As it was late, we left*), y *since* también significa «desde» (unidad 3).

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~Despite it was cold, ...~~ → **Although it was cold** o **Despite the cold**.
- ~~In spite the rain~~ → **In spite of the rain**. Lleva *of*; *despite* no.
- ~~However it was late, we continued.~~ → **Although it was late, ...** o **It was late. However, ...**
- ~~Because of it was late~~ → **Because it was late**.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. ___ the traffic, we arrived on time.
   a) Despite
   b) Although
   c) However
   d) Because

2. ___ she studied a lot, she failed the exam.
   a) Although
   b) Despite
   c) However
   d) In spite of

3. The museum was closed. ___, we visited the park.
   a) However
   b) Although
   c) Despite
   d) Because of

4. The match was cancelled ___ the storm.
   a) because of
   b) because
   c) so
   d) although

5. I was hungry, ___ I made a sandwich.
   a) so
   b) because
   c) despite
   d) however

6. My brother is very tidy, ___ I'm quite messy.
   a) whereas
   b) despite
   c) so
   d) because of

7. In spite _____ the bad reviews, the film was a success.

8. Despite _____ (feel) ill, she went to work.

9. Sales fell by 20%. As a _____, several shops closed.

10. Rodea el sujeto:

    The plan was expensive. Nevertheless, the council approved it.

11. Subraya el verbo principal:

    Even though the tickets were cheap, very few people came to the concert.

12. Ordena la frase.

    We / at / because / of / the / stayed / home / snow

🔍 Lectura desmontada: Should homework be banned?

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1]In some countries schools have reduced homework or even stopped giving it, and the debate has reached Spain. [2]Supporters of homework argue that it helps students to practise what they have learnt. [3]However, critics point out that many children spend hours on tasks which do not improve their results. [4]Moreover, because not all families can help their children, homework may increase inequality. [5]Despite these concerns, most teachers do not want to ban homework completely. [6]Instead, they suggest shorter, more creative tasks, such as reading a book or interviewing a grandparent.

Vocabulario de la lectura

homework	deberes
reduce	reducir
reach	llegar a
supporter	defensor/a, partidario/a
argue that	sostener que
critic	crítico/a
point out	señalar
improve	mejorar
moreover	además
increase	aumentar
inequality	desigualdad
concern	preocupación
ban	prohibir
instead	en su lugar
such as	como (por ejemplo)
interview	entrevistar

Preguntas

1. What do supporters of homework believe?
   a) It increases inequality.
   b) It helps students practise.
   c) It should be creative.
   d) It should be banned.

2. Why may homework increase inequality?
   a) Because some families cannot help their children.
   b) Because it is too long.
   c) Because teachers give different tasks.
   d) Because it is boring.

3. What do most teachers propose?
   a) Banning homework completely.
   b) Giving more homework.
   c) Shorter and more creative tasks.
   d) Only reading at home.

B1+ · UNIDAD 6

Narrar en pasado

Past continuous, past perfect y used to.

📖 Teoría

Tres tiempos para contar una historia

Para contar algo que pasó, el inglés combina tres tiempos. Cada uno tiene un papel:

Tiempo	Papel en la historia	Ejemplo
Past simple	Los hechos principales, uno detrás de otro	I **opened** the door and **saw** a cat.
Past continuous	El fondo: lo que estaba pasando	It **was raining** and people **were running**.
Past perfect	Lo que había pasado antes	Someone **had left** the window open.

Past continuous: lo que estaba pasando

was / were + verbo-ing

Describe una acción en progreso en un momento del pasado. Muy a menudo, otra acción corta (past simple) la interrumpe:

> I **was cooking** **when** the phone **rang**.
>
> **While** we **were walking** home, it started to snow.

When suele ir con la acción corta y **while** con la larga.

Past perfect: el pasado del pasado

had + participio

Se usa cuando ya estás contando algo en pasado y necesitas ir **más atrás**:

> When I arrived at the station, the train **had already left**.
>
> → Primero se fue el tren; después llegué yo.

Compara: *When I arrived, the train **left*** = llegué y en ese momento salió. Con *had left*, ya no estaba.

Al leer, **'d** puede ser *had* o *would*. Si detrás va un participio, es *had*: *She'd finished* = she had finished.

Used to: costumbres que ya no existen

used to + infinitivo

> I **used to** play football every weekend. (antes sí, ahora no)
>
> There **used to** be a cinema here. (antes había, ya no)
>
> Did you **use to** live in Madrid? · I **didn't use to** like coffee.

No confundir con **be used to** + **-ing** (estar acostumbrado), de la unidad 1 del examen: *I'm used to getting up early.*

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~When I was child, I was going to the beach every summer.~~ → **I used to go** o **I went**. El imperfecto español de costumbre («iba») no es past continuous.
- ~~I use to play tennis.~~ (hablando del pasado) → **I used to play tennis.**
- ~~When I arrived, she already left.~~ → **she had already left**.
- ~~I was knowing the answer.~~ → **I knew the answer.** Verbos de estado (know, like, want, believe) no van en continuo.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. I ___ a shower when the lights went out.
   a) was having
   b) had
   c) have had
   d) had had

2. By the time the police arrived, the thieves ___.
   a) had escaped
   b) escaped
   c) were escaping
   d) have escaped

3. When I was a child, I ___ to the beach every summer.
   a) used to go
   b) was going
   c) had gone
   d) use to go

4. ___ she was reading, her brother was watching TV.
   a) While
   b) When
   c) During
   d) For

5. She didn't recognise me because she ___ me for years.
   a) hadn't seen
   b) didn't see
   c) wasn't seeing
   d) hasn't seen

6. There ___ a bakery on this corner, but it closed.
   a) used to be
   b) was being
   c) had been being
   d) is used to be

7. I didn't _____ to like vegetables, but now I love them.

8. What _____ you doing at 9 o'clock last night?

9. When we got to the cinema, the film had already _____. (start)

10. Subraya el verbo principal:
    While I was waiting for the bus, I met an old friend.

11. ¿Qué significa "She'd left"?
    a) She had left.
    b) She would left.
    c) She did left.
    d) She has left.

12. Ordena la frase.
    It / raining / we / house / was / the / when / left

🔍 Lectura desmontada: The wrong train

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1]Last winter I was travelling to Edinburgh for a job interview. [2]I had prepared everything carefully the night before: my clothes were ready and I had printed my train ticket. [3]But while I was reading my notes on the platform, I didn't notice that the platform number had changed. [4]I got on the first train that arrived and fell asleep. [5]When I woke up, the train was crossing a bridge and I could see the sea. [6]I realised that I had taken the train to Glasgow. [7]I arrived two hours late, but they gave me the job anyway: the manager said she had once done exactly the same thing.

Vocabulario de la lectura

job interview	entrevista de trabajo
carefully	con cuidado
the night before	la noche anterior
print	imprimir
platform	andén
notice	darse cuenta de
get on	subirse a (un tren, un bus)
fall asleep	quedarse dormido
wake up (woke, woken)	despertarse
bridge	puente
realise	darse cuenta
anyway	de todos modos
manager	director/a, jefe/a
once	una vez

Preguntas

1. Why was the writer going to Edinburgh?
   a) To visit a friend.
   b) For a job interview.
   c) To see the sea.
   d) For a holiday.

2. Why did the writer take the wrong train?
   a) The ticket was wrong.
   b) He did not notice the platform had changed.
   c) The train was late.
   d) He arrived late at the station.

3. Why did the manager give him the job?
   a) He had excellent notes.
   b) Nobody else applied.
   c) She had made the same mistake once.
   d) He apologised.

B1+ · UNIDAD 7

Condicionales 0, 1 y 2

Situaciones reales e hipotéticas.

📖 Teoría

La idea: ¿qué tan real es la condición?

Un condicional tiene dos partes: la **condición** (con *if*) y el **resultado**. El tiempo verbal te dice cuánto de real es la situación:

Tipo	Situación	Forma
0	Siempre es verdad	If + presente, presente
1	Posible en el futuro	If + presente, will + infinitivo
2	Imaginaria o poco probable	If + pasado, would + infinitivo

Condicional 0: verdades generales

> If you **heat** ice, it **melts**.
>
> If I **drink** coffee at night, I **can't** sleep.

If aquí funciona casi como *when* («siempre que»).

Condicional 1: lo que puede pasar

> If it **rains** tomorrow, we **will stay** at home.
>
> You'**ll miss** the bus if you **don't hurry**.

Regla de oro: después de *if* nunca va *will*. Lo mismo con **when, as soon as, unless, before, until**:

> I'll call you when I **arrive**. ✓ · ~~when I will arrive~~ ✗

Unless = if not: *You won't pass unless you study.* = if you don't study.

Condicional 2: lo imaginario

> If I **had** more money, I **would travel** more. (no tengo)
>
> If I **were** you, I **wouldn't buy** it. (consejo)
>
> What **would** you **do** if you **won** the lottery?

El pasado aquí **no habla del pasado**: habla de un presente o futuro imaginario. Con *be* se usa **were** para todas las personas, sobre todo en «If I were you».

En los textos: if no siempre va primero

El orden puede cambiar. Si *if* va primero, se pone coma; si va segundo, no:

> If you need help, call me. · Call me if you need help.

Al leer, busca el esqueleto en la parte **sin if**: esa es la frase principal.

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~If it will rain, …~~ → **If it rains, …**
- ~~If I would have money, …~~ → **If I had money, …** (en español: «si tuviera», nunca «si tendría»).
- ~~If I was you…~~ → **If I were you…** (en el examen, mejor *were*).
- ~~I'll tell you when I will know.~~ → **when I know**.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. If you mix red and white, you ___ pink.
   a) get
   b) will got
   c) would get
   d) got

2. If it ___ tomorrow, we'll cancel the trip.
   a) rains
   b) will rain
   c) would rain
   d) rained

3. If I ___ rich, I would buy a house by the sea.
   a) were
   b) am
   c) will be
   d) would be

4. I'll phone you as soon as I ___ home.
   a) get
   b) will get
   c) got
   d) would get

5. You won't pass the exam ___ you study harder.
   a) unless
   b) if
   c) when
   d) as soon as

6. If I were you, I ___ that email.
   a) wouldn't send
   b) won't send
   c) don't send
   d) didn't send

7. What _____ you do if you lost your passport abroad?

8. If she _____ (have) more time, she would learn to paint.

9. If you don't hurry, you _____ miss the train.

10. Subraya el verbo principal:
    If the weather is good this weekend, we will go hiking in the mountains.

11. ¿Qué significa? "If I had a car, I would drive to work."
    a) No tengo coche.
    b) Tengo coche.
    c) Tuve coche antes.
    d) Voy a comprar un coche.

12. Ordena la frase.
    If / would / you / I / I / were / apologise

🔍 Lectura desmontada: What if we all worked four days a week?

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1]If you could choose, would you work four longer days or five shorter ones? [2]Several companies in the UK have tested a four-day week without cutting salaries. [3]Most of them found that if employees have a three-day weekend, they come back more rested and make fewer mistakes. [4]However, the system doesn't work for every job. [5]If a hospital closed on Fridays, patients would suffer, so hospitals would need more staff to cover the extra day. [6]Experts believe that the four-day week will spread slowly unless governments decide to support it.

Vocabulario de la lectura

choose	elegir
longer	más largo
test	probar
cut	recortar
salary	sueldo
employee	empleado/a
rested	descansado
make a mistake	cometer un error
every	todo, cada
suffer	sufrir
staff	personal, plantilla
cover	cubrir
spread	extenderse
unless	a menos que
support	apoyar

Preguntas

1. What did the UK companies test?
   a) Working from home.
   b) A four-day week with the same salary.
   c) Shorter holidays.
   d) Lower salaries.

2. What did most companies find?
   a) Employees made more mistakes.
   b) Employees were more rested.
   c) Employees wanted to work five days.
   d) Salaries had to be cut.

3. Why is a four-day week difficult for hospitals?
   a) Doctors don't want it.
   b) They would need more staff.
   c) Patients prefer Fridays.
   d) It is illegal.

B1+ · UNIDAD 8

Verbo + -ing o + to

enjoy doing, decide to do, stop/remember/try.

📖 Teoría

El problema

Cuando un verbo va seguido de otro, el segundo puede ir en **-ing** o con **to** + **infinitivo**. Depende del primer verbo, y no hay una regla perfecta: hay que aprender los más frecuentes. La buena noticia es que son pocos y salen mucho en el examen.

> I enjoy **reading**. · I want **to read**.

Verbos que van con -ing

enjoy, finish, avoid, mind, suggest, consider, keep, practise, imagine, miss, deny, can't stand, don't mind, give up, look forward to

> She **avoids driving** at night. · Would you **mind closing** the window? · I'**m looking forward to seeing** you.

Y **siempre -ing después de una preposición** (about, of, at, for, without, before, after…): *She's good at **drawing**.* · *Thanks for **helping**.*

Ojo: en *look forward to* y *be used to*, el *to* es preposición → -ing.

Verbos que van con to + infinitivo

want, decide, hope, plan, agree, refuse, promise, offer, manage, afford, learn, seem, need, would like

> We **decided to stay**. · He **refused to pay**. · I can't **afford to buy** a car. · She **managed to finish** on time.

Muchos hablan de **planes, decisiones o intenciones hacia el futuro**; eso ayuda a recordarlos.

Verbos que cambian de significado

Verbo	+ -ing	+ to
stop	dejar de: *I stopped **smoking**.*	parar para: *I stopped **to smoke**.*
remember	recordar algo pasado: *I remember **meeting** him.*	acordarse de hacer: *Remember **to lock** the door.*
forget	olvidar algo pasado: *I'll never forget **seeing** the sea.*	olvidarse de hacer: *Don't forget **to call**.*
try	probar a ver qué pasa: *Try **restarting** it.*	intentar (cuesta): *I tried **to open** it, but I couldn't.*

like, love, hate, start, begin, continue admiten los dos casi sin cambio: *I like swimming / to swim.*

Errores típicos de hispanohablantes

- ~~I enjoy to read.~~ → **I enjoy reading.**
- ~~I'm looking forward to see you.~~ → **to seeing you**.
- ~~She suggested to go out.~~ → **She suggested going out.**
- ~~I want that you come.~~ → **I want you to come.** En inglés no se dice «want that».
- ~~Before to leave, ...~~ → **Before leaving, ...** Después de preposición, -ing.

■ Sujeto ■ Verbo principal ■ Complemento ■ Oración secundaria ■ Conector ■ Información extra

✍️ Práctica

1. I really enjoy ___ in the sea.
   a) swimming
   b) to swim
   c) swim
   d) swam

2. They decided ___ a new flat.
   a) to buy
   b) buying
   c) buy
   d) bought

3. I'm looking forward to ___ you next week.
   a) seeing
   b) see
   c) saw
   d) have seen

4. He stopped ___ because it was bad for his health.
   a) smoking
   b) to smoke
   c) smoke
   d) smoked

5. Please remember ___ the lights before you go.
   a) to turn off
   b) turning off
   c) turn off
   d) turned off

6. We can't afford ___ on holiday this year.
   a) to go
   b) going
   c) go
   d) gone

7. My boss wants ___ the report today.
   a) me to finish
   b) that I finish
   c) me finish
   d) me finishing

8. Would you mind _____ (open) the window?

9. She left without _____ (say) goodbye.

10. He promised _____ call me back.

11. Subraya el verbo principal:

    Many people who try to learn a language alone give up after a few months.

12. Ordena la frase.

    meeting / my / never / I / forget / writer / will / favourite

🔍 Lectura desmontada: Learning to fail

1) Lee el texto entero sin parar. 2) En cada frase, subraya el verbo principal y rodea el sujeto **antes** de mirar las soluciones. 3) Contesta las preguntas.

[1]Most of us avoid doing things that we are not good at. [2]We are afraid of looking stupid, so we stop trying before we have really started. [3]A teacher in Barcelona decided to change this by inventing a "mistake of the week" competition. [4]Every Friday, students share the biggest mistake they have made and explain what they learnt from it. [5]At first many of them refused to take part, but after a few weeks they started looking forward to it. [6]The teacher says that her students now keep trying for longer and don't mind making mistakes in front of others.

Vocabulario de la lectura

avoid	evitar
be good at	dársele bien algo a alguien
be afraid of	tener miedo de
look stupid	quedar como un tonto
by doing	haciendo (modo)
competition	concurso
share	compartir
learn from	aprender de
at first	al principio
refuse	negarse
take part	participar
keep doing	seguir haciendo
not mind	no importar
in front of	delante de

Preguntas

1. Why do we often stop trying new things?
   a) We are too busy.
   b) We are afraid of looking stupid.
   c) We are not interested.
   d) Teachers don't help us.

2. What happens every Friday in the teacher's class?

a) Students take an exam.

b) Students share a mistake and what they learnt.

c) Students choose the best student.

d) Students correct each other's homework.

3. How have the students changed?

a) They make fewer mistakes.

b) They refuse to take part.

c) They keep trying for longer.

d) They prefer working alone.

ANEXO

Verbos irregulares

Infinitivo, pasado y participio.

be	was/were	been	ser, estar
become	became	become	convertirse
begin	began	begun	empezar
break	broke	broken	romper
bring	brought	brought	traer
build	built	built	construir
buy	bought	bought	comprar
catch	caught	caught	coger, atrapar
choose	chose	chosen	elegir
come	came	come	venir
cost	cost	cost	costar
cut	cut	cut	cortar
do	did	done	hacer
draw	drew	drawn	dibujar
drink	drank	drunk	beber
drive	drove	driven	conducir
eat	ate	eaten	comer
fall	fell	fallen	caer
feel	felt	felt	sentir
fight	fought	fought	luchar
find	found	found	encontrar
fly	flew	flown	volar
forget	forgot	forgotten	olvidar
forgive	forgave	forgiven	perdonar
get	got	got	conseguir, llegar
give	gave	given	dar
go	went	gone	ir
grow	grew	grown	crecer
have	had	had	tener
hear	heard	heard	oír
hide	hid	hidden	esconder
hit	hit	hit	golpear

hold	held	held	sostener
hurt	hurt	hurt	herir, doler
keep	kept	kept	guardar, mantener
know	knew	known	saber, conocer
lead	led	led	dirigir, llevar a
learn	learnt/learned	learnt/learned	aprender
leave	left	left	dejar, irse
lend	lent	lent	prestar
let	let	let	dejar, permitir
lie	lay	lain	tumbarse
lose	lost	lost	perder
make	made	made	hacer, fabricar
mean	meant	meant	significar
meet	met	met	conocer, quedar
pay	paid	paid	pagar
put	put	put	poner
read	read	read	leer
ride	rode	ridden	montar
ring	rang	rung	sonar, llamar
rise	rose	risen	subir, elevarse
run	ran	run	correr
say	said	said	decir
see	saw	seen	ver
sell	sold	sold	vender
send	sent	sent	enviar
set	set	set	establecer, poner
shake	shook	shaken	agitar, temblar
shine	shone	shone	brillar
shoot	shot	shot	disparar
show	showed	shown	mostrar
shut	shut	shut	cerrar
sing	sang	sung	cantar
sink	sank	sunk	hundirse
sit	sat	sat	sentarse
sleep	slept	slept	dormir
speak	spoke	spoken	hablar
spend	spent	spent	gastar, pasar (tiempo)

spread	spread	spread	extender
stand	stood	stood	estar de pie
steal	stole	stolen	robar
stick	stuck	stuck	pegar
strike	struck	struck	golpear, impactar
swim	swam	swum	nadar
take	took	taken	coger, llevar
teach	taught	taught	enseñar
tear	tore	torn	romper, rasgar
tell	told	told	contar, decir
think	thought	thought	pensar
throw	threw	thrown	lanzar
understand	understood	understood	entender
wake	woke	woken	despertar
wear	wore	worn	llevar puesto
win	won	won	ganar
write	wrote	written	escribir

✅ Soluciones

Unidad 1 · El esqueleto de la frase

Práctica

1. has lived

   "Has lived" es un solo bloque: auxiliar + participio.

2. received

   "Passed" va detrás de "who": es de la relativa. El esqueleto es "The students received a certificate".

3. The film

   El esqueleto es "The film was boring". "That we saw last night" solo dice qué película.

4. finished

   "Was" va detrás de "although": es la subordinada. El principal es "finished".

5. children

   La frase empieza por un complemento de lugar, pero el sujeto es lo que va justo delante del verbo: "children".

6. tend

   "Exercise" pertenece a la relativa. El principal es "tend" ("to sleep" es un infinitivo).

7. a) The decision was announced

   Verbos conjugados: "had employed" (detrás de "which", secundaria) y "was announced". Sujeto: "the decision" (lo que va antes, quitando las piezas).

8. a) should send

   "Wishing" es un participio sin auxiliar y "to apply" un infinitivo. El verbo conjugado es "should send".

9. a) It is important to drink water.

   En inglés el sujeto siempre aparece. Cuando no hay uno real se usa "it".

10. a) There are many problems in this city.

    "Hay/existen" = there is / there are.

11. Yesterday my parents bought a new car.

    Tiempo al principio (opcional), luego sujeto + verbo + complemento.

12. The woman who called you is my boss.

    La relativa "who called you" va pegada a "the woman". El verbo principal es "is".

13. it

    El tiempo atmosférico lleva "it" como sujeto.

14. there

    "Hay" + plural = there are.

Lectura: Why we forget what we read

1. Most of us have had the same experience: we finish a book, and a few weeks later we can remember almost nothing about it.

Casi todos hemos vivido lo mismo: terminamos un libro y, unas semanas después, apenas recordamos nada de él.

Son tres frases unidas por los dos puntos y por "and". Cada una tiene su propio esqueleto: "Most of us have had...", "we finish...", "we can remember...". Aquí "Most of us" funciona como sujeto.

2. This is not a sign that our memory is getting worse.

Esto no es señal de que nuestra memoria esté empeorando.

Esqueleto corto: "This is not a sign". "That our memory is getting worse" explica de qué es señal.

3. In fact, researchers who study memory say that forgetting is completely normal.

De hecho, los investigadores que estudian la memoria dicen que olvidar es completamente normal.

"Study" va detrás de "who": es la relativa. El verbo principal es "say". Y lo que dicen va en otra secundaria con "that".

4. The brain keeps information that it uses often and throws away the rest.

El cerebro guarda la información que usa a menudo y tira el resto.

Un sujeto con dos verbos: "The brain keeps... and throws away...". "That it uses often" dice qué información.

5. When we read a novel in one weekend, we give the brain very few chances to return to the story.

Cuando leemos una novela en un fin de semana, le damos al cerebro muy pocas ocasiones de volver a la historia.

Empieza con una subordinada ("When we read..."). Tras la coma llega el esqueleto: "we give the brain very few chances".

6. People who read a chapter a day and think about it before the next one remember much more.

Quienes leen un capítulo al día y piensan en él antes del siguiente recuerdan mucho más.

Ojo: hay tres verbos ("read", "think", "remember"). Los dos primeros van con "who" (la relativa es doble, unida por "and"). El principal es "remember": esqueleto "People remember much more".

7. Writing a short summary or explaining the plot to a friend is even more effective.

Escribir un breve resumen o explicarle la trama a un amigo es aún más eficaz.

Aquí el sujeto es largo y empieza por -ing: "Writing a short summary or explaining the plot to a friend". En inglés las acciones pueden ser sujeto con -ing. Verbo: "is".

8. So if you want to remember a book, the answer is simple: read it more slowly and talk about it.

Así que, si quieres recordar un libro, la respuesta es sencilla: léelo más despacio y habla de él.

Esqueleto: "the answer is simple". Después de los dos puntos vienen dos imperativos ("read", "talk"), que no tienen sujeto porque son órdenes.

Preguntas

1. b) is completely normal.

2. c) Because the brain has few chances to return to the story.
3. c) Reading slowly and talking about the book.

Unidad 2 · Oraciones de relativo

Práctica

1. a) who
   Persona y sujeto de la relativa → who (o that).
2. a) where
   Lugar en el que pasa algo → where.
3. a) whose
   Posesión (su hermano) → whose. "Who's" es "who is".
4. a) who
   Relativa con comas: no se puede usar "that" ni quitar el pronombre.
5. a) The film that we watched was boring.
   Solo cuando el pronombre es el objeto (detrás viene otro sujeto: "we"). → The film we watched was boring.
6. a) El piso que alquilaron era diminuto.
   Nombre + sujeto + verbo ("the flat they rented") = relativa con el pronombre omitido.
7. a) must bring
   "Taking the exam tomorrow" es una relativa reducida (= who are taking). El principal es "must bring".
8. a) The book that I lent you was mine.
   No se repite el objeto ("it"), y para cosas: that / which. "What" no es relativo después de un nombre.
9. whose
   El perro de la chica → whose.
10. which / that
    Cosa y sujeto de la relativa → which / that.
11. when / that
    Momento → when (o that, más informal).
12. to / about / with
    La preposición se queda al final: talk to / talk about / talk with.
13. were
    "Built after the war" es una relativa reducida pasiva (= which were built). El principal es "were".
14. has closed
    "My parents recommended" es una relativa sin pronombre (= that my parents recommended). El principal: "has closed".
15. The man whose wallet I found gave me a reward.
    Esqueleto: The man gave me a reward. La relativa "whose wallet I found" va pegada a "the man".

Lectura: The library that never closes

1. In a small village in Wales there is a red telephone box that no longer has a telephone.

En un pueblo pequeño de Gales hay una cabina de teléfono roja que ya no tiene teléfono.

"There is" + sujeto: el esqueleto es "there is a red telephone box". La relativa con "that" dice qué tiene de especial.

2. Instead, the shelves people have built inside it are full of books which anyone can borrow for free.

En su lugar, las estanterías que la gente ha construido dentro están llenas de libros que cualquiera puede llevarse prestados gratis.

Relativa escondida: "the shelves people have built" = las estanterías QUE la gente ha construido. Esqueleto: "the shelves are full of books".

3. The idea came from a retired teacher whose house is next to the box.

La idea fue de una profesora jubilada cuya casa está al lado de la cabina.

"Whose house" = cuya casa. Esqueleto corto: "The idea came from a retired teacher".

4. She wanted to create a place where neighbours could share the books they had already read.

Quería crear un lugar donde los vecinos pudieran compartir los libros que ya habían leído.

Dos relativas seguidas: "where neighbours could share the books" y "(that) they had already read". Fíjate en "the books they had read": nombre + sujeto + verbo.

5. Today the box, which is open day and night, contains more than three hundred books.

Hoy la cabina, que está abierta día y noche, contiene más de trescientos libros.

Relativa con comas: es información extra. Tápala y queda "the box contains more than three hundred books".

6. Visitors passing through the village often stop to take a photo or leave a book of their own.

Los visitantes que pasan por el pueblo a menudo se paran a hacer una foto o a dejar un libro suyo.

"Passing through the village" es una relativa reducida (= who are passing). Esqueleto: "Visitors stop… or leave…".

7. The teacher says that the books people choose to leave tell you a lot about the village.

La profesora dice que los libros que la gente decide dejar te cuentan mucho sobre el pueblo.

Difícil: dentro de "that…" hay otra relativa escondida ("the books people choose to leave" = los libros QUE la gente decide dejar), y su verbo es "tell". Esqueleto de la frase entera: "The teacher says…". Esqueleto de lo que dice: "the books tell you a lot".

Preguntas

1. b) It is used as a small library.
2. c) A retired teacher who lives next to it.
3. b) say a lot about the village.

Unidad 3 · Present perfect o past simple

Práctica

1. a) have lost

   El resultado importa ahora (no lo encuentro): present perfect.

2. a) went

   "Last summer" es un momento terminado → past simple.

3. a) has worked

   Empezó en 2020 y sigue → present perfect con "since".

4. a) Have / ridden

   Experiencia en tu vida, con "ever" → present perfect: have + participio (ride → rode → ridden).

5. a) ago

   "Ago" = hace (tiempo). Siempre con past simple.

6. a) 've had

   "Today" no ha terminado → present perfect.

7. yet

   "Yet" va al final, en preguntas y negativas: ¿ya...? / todavía no.

8. since

   "Since" + punto de inicio (también una oración: since we were at school).

9. for

   "For" + duración.

10. did

    Pregunta con "when" → momento concreto → past simple.

11. has doubled

    "Work" es de la relativa. Esqueleto: "The number has doubled". Ojo: el sujeto es "the number" (singular), por eso "has".

12. I have never been to Ireland.

    "Never" va entre have y el participio.

Lectura: The village that went offline

1. A small village in the north of Scotland has decided to switch off its public Wi-Fi every Sunday.

Un pueblo pequeño del norte de Escocia ha decidido apagar su wifi público todos los domingos.

Empieza en present perfect: es la noticia, lo nuevo. El sujeto es largo ("A small village in the north of Scotland") y el verbo es "has decided".

2. The idea came from a group of parents who were worried about their children's screen time.

La idea surgió de un grupo de padres a los que les preocupaba el tiempo de pantalla de sus hijos.

Ahora pasa a past simple ("came") para contar los detalles. "Who were worried..." es una relativa sobre los padres.

3. Last spring they organised a meeting and most of the village voted in favour.

La primavera pasada organizaron una reunión y la mayor parte del pueblo votó a favor.

"Last spring" = momento terminado → past simple. Dos esqueletos unidos por "and".

4. Since then, the local café has started a board games afternoon and the library has seen more visitors than ever.

Desde entonces, la cafetería del pueblo ha empezado una tarde de juegos de mesa y la biblioteca ha tenido más visitantes que nunca.

"Since then" conecta con el presente → present perfect. Fíjate en "has seen more visitors": en inglés, un lugar puede "ver" visitantes.

5. Not everyone has been happy, however.

Sin embargo, no todo el mundo ha estado contento.

"However" puede ir al final de la frase. Esqueleto: "Not everyone has been happy".

6. Some teenagers complained that they had nothing to do, and two of them walked five kilometres to the next town to find a signal.

Algunos adolescentes se quejaron de que no tenían nada que hacer, y dos de ellos caminaron cinco kilómetros hasta el siguiente pueblo para encontrar cobertura.

Dos esqueletos: "Some teenagers complained…" y "two of them walked…". "To find a signal" explica para qué.

7. But so far the experiment has worked and other villages have asked how they can do the same.

Pero, hasta ahora, el experimento ha funcionado y otros pueblos han preguntado cómo pueden hacer lo mismo.

"So far" (hasta ahora) es una pista clara de present perfect.

Preguntas

1. b) Turn off public Wi-Fi on Sundays.
2. c) Some worried parents.
3. b) They have asked for information.

Unidad 4 · La pasiva

Práctica

1. a) was built

   El castillo no construye: lo construyeron. Pasado → was + participio.
2. a) is spoken

   Presente pasivo: is + participio (speak → spoken).
3. a) has been cancelled

   El partido no cancela nada: lo cancelan. Present perfect pasivo: has been + participio.
4. a) will be delivered

   Futuro pasivo: will be + participio.
5. a) is being repaired

   Ahora mismo (continuo) + pasiva: is being + participio.
6. a) I was born in 1998.

   "Nacer" = be born. En pasado: I was born.
7. by

   Quién hace la acción en pasiva: by.
8. be

   Modal + be + participio.
9. announced

   Después de "be" va el participio: announced.

10. have been planted

    Present perfect pasivo: "have been planted" es un solo bloque.

11. The new hospital,

    Esqueleto: "The new hospital will be opened". La relativa con comas es información extra.

12. The thief was arrested by the police.

    Pasiva: sujeto (lo que recibe la acción) + was + participio + by + quien la hace.

Lectura: How a pencil is made

1. Billions of pencils are produced every year, but few people know how they are made.

Cada año se producen miles de millones de lápices, pero poca gente sabe cómo se fabrican.

Dos pasivas: "are produced" y "are made". Fíjate en que en español usamos "se".

2. First, the wood is cut into thin blocks which are called slats.

Primero, la madera se corta en bloques finos que se llaman tablillas.

"Is cut": cut es irregular y su participio es igual (cut – cut – cut). La relativa "which are called slats" también es pasiva.

3. Then small grooves are made in each slat, and the "lead" is placed inside them.

Luego se hacen pequeñas ranuras en cada tablilla y se coloca dentro la "mina".

Dos pasivas unidas por "and". Ningún "by": no importa quién lo hace (máquinas).

4. Surprisingly, this "lead" is not made of lead at all: it is a mixture of graphite and clay.

Sorprendentemente, esta "mina" no está hecha de plomo en absoluto: es una mezcla de grafito y arcilla.

"Lead" significa plomo; en español la llamamos "mina". "Be made of" = estar hecho de. "Surprisingly" es un comentario del autor (información extra).

5. A second slat is glued on top, and the "sandwich" is cut into individual pencils.

Encima se pega una segunda tablilla y el "sándwich" se corta en lápices individuales.

Las instrucciones de un proceso casi siempre van en pasiva presente.

6. Finally, they are painted, sharpened and packed into boxes.

Por último, se pintan, se les saca punta y se meten en cajas.

Un solo "are" vale para los tres participios: are painted, (are) sharpened and (are) packed.

7. The yellow colour that is used on most American pencils was chosen in the 1890s because the best graphite came from China, where yellow was linked to royalty.

El color amarillo que se usa en la mayoría de lápices estadounidenses se eligió en la década de 1890 porque el mejor grafito venía de China, donde el amarillo se asociaba a la realeza.

Frase difícil. Esqueleto: "The yellow colour was chosen". Todo lo demás cuelga: qué color (relativa), cuándo, por qué, y dónde (otra relativa con "where").

Preguntas

1. b) Graphite and clay.
2. c) The "sandwich" is cut into pencils.
3. b) It was linked to Chinese royalty.

Unidad 5 · Conectores de contraste y causa

Práctica

1. a) Despite
   Detrás viene un sustantivo ("the traffic") y hay contraste → despite.
2. a) Although
   Detrás viene una frase completa (she studied) → although.
3. a) However
   Empieza una frase nueva tras el punto → however.
4. a) because of
   Causa + sustantivo → because of.
5. a) so
   Consecuencia dentro de la misma frase → so.
6. a) whereas
   Compara dos cosas opuestas → whereas (o while).
7. of
   "In spite of" siempre lleva "of".
8. feeling
   Después de "despite" va un sustantivo o un verbo en -ing.
9. result
   "As a result" = como consecuencia.
10. Nevertheless,
    "Nevertheless" = sin embargo (formal). Anuncia algo que va en contra de lo anterior.
11. came
    "Were" está en la subordinada con "even though". Esqueleto: "very few people came".
12. We stayed at home because of the snow.
    "Because of" + sustantivo.

Lectura: Should homework be banned?

1. In some countries schools have reduced homework or even stopped giving it, and the debate has reached Spain.

En algunos países los colegios han reducido los deberes o incluso han dejado de ponerlos, y el debate ha llegado a España.

Dos esqueletos unidos por "and". "Or even stopped giving it" comparte el sujeto "schools".

2. Supporters of homework argue that it helps students to practise what they have learnt.

Los defensores de los deberes sostienen que ayudan a los alumnos a practicar lo que han aprendido.

"Argue" en inglés suele significar "sostener, defender una idea", no solo "discutir".

3. However, critics point out that many children spend hours on tasks which do not improve their results.

Sin embargo, los críticos señalan que muchos niños dedican horas a tareas que no mejoran sus resultados.

"However" anuncia el otro lado del debate. "Point out" = señalar, hacer notar.

4. Moreover, because not all families can help their children, homework may increase inequality.

Además, como no todas las familias pueden ayudar a sus hijos, los deberes pueden aumentar la desigualdad.

"Moreover" = además (añade otro argumento en la misma dirección). La causa va delante con "because".

5. Despite these concerns, most teachers do not want to ban homework completely.

A pesar de estas preocupaciones, la mayoría de los profesores no quiere prohibir los deberes por completo.

"Despite these concerns": despite + sustantivo. Esqueleto: "most teachers do not want to ban homework".

6. Instead, they suggest shorter, more creative tasks, such as reading a book or interviewing a grandparent.

En su lugar, proponen tareas más cortas y creativas, como leer un libro o entrevistar a un abuelo.

"Such as" introduce ejemplos. Detrás de "such as" los verbos van en -ing.

Preguntas

1. b) It helps students practise.
2. a) Because some families cannot help their children.
3. c) Shorter and more creative tasks.

Unidad 6 · Narrar en pasado

Práctica

1. a) was having
   Acción en progreso interrumpida por otra corta → past continuous.
2. a) had escaped
   Pasó antes de que llegara la policía → past perfect.
3. a) used to go
   Costumbre del pasado → used to (o past simple). No past continuous.
4. a) While
   Dos acciones largas a la vez → while.
5. a) hadn't seen
   Causa anterior al momento pasado → past perfect.
6. a) used to be
   Situación pasada que ya no existe → used to be.

7. use

   En negativa y pregunta, sin -d: didn't use to.

8. were

   Past continuous en pregunta: were you doing.

9. started

   Past perfect: had + participio.

10. met

    "Was waiting" está en la subordinada con "while". El hecho principal: "I met an old friend".

11. a) She had left.

    'd + participio = had. ('d + infinitivo = would.)

12. It was raining when we left the house.

    Fondo (past continuous) + acción corta (past simple) con when.

Lectura: The wrong train

1. Last winter I was travelling to Edinburgh for a job interview.

El invierno pasado viajaba a Edimburgo para una entrevista de trabajo.

Past continuous para poner el fondo de la historia.

2. I had prepared everything carefully the night before: my clothes were ready and I had printed my train ticket.

Lo había preparado todo con cuidado la noche anterior: tenía la ropa lista y había impreso el billete de tren.

Past perfect ("had prepared", "had printed") porque es anterior al viaje.

3. But while I was reading my notes on the platform, I didn't notice that the platform number had changed.

Pero mientras leía mis apuntes en el andén, no me di cuenta de que había cambiado el número de andén.

Tres tiempos en una frase: fondo (was reading), hecho principal (didn't notice) y algo anterior (had changed).

4. I got on the first train that arrived and fell asleep.

Me subí al primer tren que llegó y me quedé dormido.

Hechos principales seguidos → past simple. "Fall asleep" = quedarse dormido.

5. When I woke up, the train was crossing a bridge and I could see the sea.

Cuando me desperté, el tren estaba cruzando un puente y podía ver el mar.

Acción corta (woke up) + lo que estaba pasando en ese momento (was crossing).

6. I realised that I had taken the train to Glasgow.

Me di cuenta de que había cogido el tren a Glasgow.

"Had taken" es anterior a "realised".

7. I arrived two hours late, but they gave me the job anyway: the manager said she had once done exactly the same thing.

Llegué dos horas tarde, pero me dieron el trabajo igualmente: la directora dijo que una vez había hecho exactamente lo mismo.

"Anyway" = de todos modos. Fíjate en la relativa escondida sin "that": "said (that) she had once done…".

Preguntas

1. b) For a job interview.
2. b) He did not notice the platform had changed.
3. c) She had made the same mistake once.

Unidad 7 · Condicionales 0, 1 y 2

Práctica

1. a) get
   Verdad general → condicional 0: presente + presente.
2. a) rains
   Después de "if" no va "will". Condicional 1: if + presente.
3. a) were
   Situación imaginaria → condicional 2: if + pasado (were).
4. a) get
   "As soon as" funciona como "if": presente, no will.
5. a) unless
   "Unless" = if not.
6. a) wouldn't send
   Consejo con condicional 2: would + infinitivo.
7. would
   Situación imaginaria → would.
8. had
   Condicional 2: if + pasado.
9. will / ll
   Condicional 1: will + infinitivo.
10. will go
    La parte con "if" es la condición. El esqueleto es "we will go hiking".
11. a) No tengo coche.
    El condicional 2 habla de algo irreal ahora: no tengo coche.
12. If I were you I would apologise.
    Fórmula fija de consejo: If I were you, I would…

Lectura: What if we all worked four days a week?

1. If you could choose, would you work four longer days or five shorter ones?

Si pudieras elegir, ¿trabajarías cuatro días más largos o cinco más cortos?

Pregunta en condicional 2: es una situación imaginaria. En las preguntas, "would" va delante del sujeto.

2. Several companies in the UK have tested a four-day week without cutting salaries.

Varias empresas del Reino Unido han probado la semana de cuatro días sin recortar los sueldos.

"Without + -ing" = sin hacer algo.

3. Most of them found that if employees have a three-day weekend, they come back more rested and make fewer mistakes.

La mayoría descubrió que, si los empleados tienen un fin de semana de tres días, vuelven más descansados y cometen menos errores.

Dentro de lo que encontraron hay un condicional 0 (verdad general): if + presente, presente.

4. However, the system doesn't work for every job.

Sin embargo, el sistema no funciona para todos los trabajos.

Frase corta que marca el contraste.

5. If a hospital closed on Fridays, patients would suffer, so hospitals would need more staff to cover the extra day.

Si un hospital cerrara los viernes, los pacientes sufrirían, así que los hospitales necesitarían más personal para cubrir el día extra.

Condicional 2: situación imaginaria. Esqueletos: "patients would suffer" y "hospitals would need more staff".

6. Experts believe that the four-day week will spread slowly unless governments decide to support it.

Los expertos creen que la semana de cuatro días se extenderá lentamente a menos que los gobiernos decidan apoyarla.

"Unless" = if not. Fíjate: "unless governments decide" en presente, aunque hable del futuro.

Preguntas

1. b) A four-day week with the same salary.
2. b) Employees were more rested.
3. b) They would need more staff.

Unidad 8 · Verbo + -ing o + to

Práctica

1. a) swimming

   "Enjoy" va con -ing.

2. a) to buy

   "Decide" va con to + infinitivo.

3. a) seeing

   En "look forward to", "to" es preposición → -ing.

4. a) smoking

   Dejar de hacer algo → stop + -ing.

5. a) to turn off

   Acordarse de hacer algo (futuro) → remember + to.

6. a) to go

   "Afford" va con to + infinitivo.

7. a) me to finish

   want + persona + to + infinitivo. Nunca "want that".

8. opening

   "Mind" va con -ing.

9. saying

   Después de una preposición (without) → -ing.

10. to

    "Promise" va con to + infinitivo.

11. give up

    "Try to learn" está dentro de la relativa. El esqueleto es "Many people give up".

12. I will never forget meeting my favourite writer.

    forget + -ing = no olvidar algo que ya pasó.

Lectura: Learning to fail

1. Most of us avoid doing things that we are not good at.

La mayoría evitamos hacer cosas que no se nos dan bien.

"Avoid + -ing". Al final, la preposición "at" se queda sola: "things we are not good at" (unidad 2).

2. We are afraid of looking stupid, so we stop trying before we have really started.

Tenemos miedo de quedar como tontos, así que dejamos de intentarlo antes de haber empezado de verdad.

"Afraid of + -ing" (preposición) y "stop + -ing" (dejar de).

3. A teacher in Barcelona decided to change this by inventing a "mistake of the week" competition.

Una profesora de Barcelona decidió cambiar esto inventándose un concurso de "el error de la semana".

"Decide + to". "By + -ing" explica cómo lo hizo.

4. Every Friday, students share the biggest mistake they have made and explain what they learnt from it.

Cada viernes, los alumnos comparten el mayor error que han cometido y explican qué aprendieron de él.

Relativa escondida: "the biggest mistake (that) they have made".

5. At first many of them refused to take part, but after a few weeks they started looking forward to it.

Al principio muchos se negaron a participar, pero al cabo de unas semanas empezaron a esperarlo con ganas.

"Refuse + to" y "look forward to + it". "Start" admite -ing o to.

6. The teacher says that her students now keep trying for longer and don't mind making mistakes in front of others.

La profesora dice que ahora sus alumnos siguen intentándolo durante más tiempo y no les importa equivocarse delante de los demás.

"Keep + -ing" (seguir haciendo) y "not mind + -ing" (no importar).

Preguntas

1. b) We are afraid of looking stupid.
2. b) Students share a mistake and what they learnt.
3. c) They keep trying for longer.